HuJI had a separate branch for its operation in Indian-held Kashmir, which was semi-autonomous but ultimately came under the central management. Its other important departments were *Dawat-o-Irshad* (propagation), military and training camps, finance, organisation, broadcast/media and publication.

When HuJI joined hands with Afghan Mujahedeen in the struggle against the Soviet forces, financial support was provided by sympathisers throughout Pakistan, including various affluent individuals, private sector entities, NGOs, Pakistan government and peer organisations. For example, the Pakistani Punjabi business community heavily funded HuJI missions primarily during its founding in 1980 (Centre for Defence Information, 2004). HuJI allegedly received funding from international Islamic NGOs and madrasahs operating in Pakistan (The Investigative Project on Terrorism, 2005). Later, Al Qaeda and Osama bin Laden also directly supported the organisation (*The New York Times*, 2011).

The main goal of the group was to support the Kashmiri freedom fighters to liberate Kashmir from Indian occupation. They were willing to use the military means to fulfill these objectives and to implement their ideology.

According to various sources, HuJI had close relationships with Al Qaeda and both shared some training camps. This relationship developed due to HuJI's closeness with Afghan Taliban and its long presence in Afghanistan. According to some reports, HuJI facilitated Al Qaeda as its support network inside Pakistan, specifically to convey messages, instructions and funds. Some evidence indicated that HuJI operatives might have helped in hiding or transporting bin Laden in Pakistan (*The New York Times*, 2011). Ilyas Kashmiri, the operational commander of HuJI, who was killed in the drone attack, also served as Al Qaeda's military commander and was a senior leader in its external operations council (*The Long War Journal*, 2011).

HuJI was declared a foreign terrorist organisation by the US Department of State in March 2008 (US State Department, 2008) which froze all of its financial assets and accounts (Country Reports on Terrorism, 2012).

Since then, HuJI's operations reduced in Pakistan when compared to the pre-2003 era. Its involvement in supporting the freedom fighters in Indian-held Kashmir also came to an end. The likely involvement of its